

Teacher card

Evaluating survivor testimony / LAUNCH_S1_W03

Outcome: Evaluate survivor testimony from a curated online archive.

Evidence to retain: F: source annotations, evidence selection and evaluation.

Forty minute route

Arrival 4 min; starter 3; model 6; shared task 7; check 2; independent 12; review 3; exit 3.
Pause time is flexible.

Preparation

Choose one independent route. Print the evidence and shared cards, required visual or data sheet, route worksheet and exit. The organiser is one separate A4 page. Keep answers with staff.

Explain the content before starting. Offer a planned break and a factual written route. Never simulate persecution. Teacher previews any external archive page or video. The supplied four-word excerpt and paraphrase provide a non-graphic written route. The external page also contains family-loss context; preview it before projecting. Do not invent a recording date if the item page does not state one.

Access and regulation

Pre-teach terminology and model evidence use. Chunk sources and data; provide an initial frame, then reduce it. Maintain normal access arrangements. Extend by weighing limitations, alternative explanations and evidence quality. Adults support access and evidence selection without supplying answers. For sensitive material, explain content beforehand, offer a short regulated break and avoid graphic imagery, simulation or role-play.

Offer a predictable start, private response and agreed pause. No cold calling or forced personal disclosure. Rejoin at one clearly named next step. Keep teen-appropriate examples and the same learning goal across response modes.

Use sensitive content warnings where relevant. Do not ask for family details or personal experiences.

Assessment

Use questioning and the exit response to decide the next step. Record the learner's individual contribution and the access support used.

UAS: no approved unit code is supplied. Match the learner's evidence to the centre-selected unit and exact criteria before submission. This pack makes no automatic award claim.

Model and answers

Read these pages before teaching. Hide the model during independent assessment.

Question: Can a survivor's account reveal something a policy document may miss?

Evidence: C Gerda Haas remembers Ansbach: In her later oral history, Gerda Schild Haas recalls that religion mattered in her family. She describes Jewish affiliation appearing on forms and in community life in Ansbach before persecution.

Think aloud: Yes. It can reveal personal experience and remembered meaning.

Check: Does one testimony represent all Jewish lives? No. Evaluate its particular perspective and context.

Arrival answers

1. Nazi Germany, its allies and collaborators murdered six million European Jews.
2. A serious struggle including war
3. Yes. It can reveal personal experience and remembered meaning.
4. No. Evaluate its particular perspective and context.

Shared activity reasoning

1. One person's remembered experience — Reveals. This is the scope of the personal account.
2. Every family lived identically — Cannot establish. One account is not universal.
3. Recording context matters — Evaluation. When and why it was recorded can inform interpretation.

Exit responses

Can a survivor's account reveal something a policy document may miss? Yes. It can reveal personal experience and remembered meaning.

Does one testimony represent all Jewish lives? No. Evaluate its particular perspective and context.

Teaching and evidence record

Supplied scheme of work teaching sequence: Model source interrogation; annotate what a short testimony reveals and its limitations; write an evidence-based evaluation. No simulation or role-play.

Look for

F: source annotations, evidence selection and evaluation.

Accept accurate equivalents, including speech or exact scribing. Check the concept and use of evidence rather than length or handwriting. Record access support separately from content prompting.

BUILD: a concrete example with a reason or demonstrated action. GROW: explain or compare with a relevant detail. LAUNCH: connect evidence and reasoning; use a limitation when the outcome requires it. Keep RE responses non-GCSE.

Media

Original captioned teaching model made for this pack. It demonstrates the supplied reasoning; it is not historical footage, survivor testimony or a documentary. The full transcript and factual source credits are included.

Use manual steps for a calm pace. The silent MP4 has visible captions and a matching text transcript. External archive media is optional and should be previewed before class.

Source credits

United States Holocaust Memorial Museum introduction

<https://encyclopedia.ushmm.org/content/en/article/introduction-to-the-holocaust>

Gerda Haas prewar community testimony <https://encyclopedia.ushmm.org/content/en/oral-history/gerda-haas-describes-prewar-jewish-community-life-in-ansbach>

Source access was checked on 19 September 2026. Restricted links are listed in Sources_and_checks.html; a restriction here is not proof that the page is dead. Offline teaching material remains available.